

Carly Urban
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Academic Employment

Montana State University <i>Professor of Economics</i>	Bozeman, MT 2022-present
Montana State University <i>Associate Professor of Economics</i>	Bozeman, MT 2017-2022
Montana State University <i>Assistant Professor of Economics</i>	Bozeman, MT 2012-2017

Other Appointments

OECD International Network on Financial Education (INFE) <i>Research Advisory Group Member</i>	Paris, France 2025-present
G53 Financial Literacy Network <i>Member</i>	2021-present
Retirement and Disability Research Consortium; Social Security Administration <i>Associate Director of Training</i>	UW-Madison 2022-2024
Centre for Responsible Banking and Finance, University of St. Andrews <i>Academic Fellow</i>	St. Andrews, Scotland 2023-present
TIAA Institute <i>Academic Fellow</i>	New York, NY 2021-present
Institute for Labor Studies (IZA) at LISER <i>Research Fellow</i>	Belval, Luxembourg 2019-present
Consumer Financial Protection Bureau <i>(Remote) Visiting Scholar through the Inter-Personnel Act (IPA)</i>	Washington, DC 2017-2020
Federal Reserve Board <i>Visiting Scholar</i>	Washington, DC 2013-2014

Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison <i>Ph.D. Economics</i>	Madison, WI 2012
University of Wisconsin-Madison <i>M.S. Economics</i>	Madison, WI 2011
The George Washington University <i>B.A. Economics and International Affairs</i>	Washington, D.C. 2006

Selected Publications

HOUSEHOLD FINANCE

Financial Education Affects Financial Knowledge and Downstream Behaviors
with Tim Kaiser, Annamaria Lusardi, and Lukas Menkhoff, Journal of Financial Economics, 2022

Does State-Mandated Financial Education Affect Financial Well-being?
with Jeremy Burke and J. Michael Collins, Journal of Money, Credit, and Banking, forthcoming

Minor Bank Account Laws, Account Ownership, and Downstream Behaviors
with J. Michael Collins and Jeff Larrimore, Review of Economics of the Household, 2024

High School Financial Education Courses in the U.S.: What is the Importance of Setting State Policies?
with Allison Luedtke, the Journal of Financial Literacy and Well-being, 2024

Association of Severe COVID-19 and Persistent COVID-19 Symptoms With Economic Hardship
with Nicole Hair, JAMA Network Open, 2023

Does State-mandated Financial Education Reduce High School Graduation Rates?
Economics of Education Review, 2023

Does Financial Education Affect Retirement Savings?
with Melody Harvey, Journal of Economics of Ageing, 2023

Why are Mortgage Rates Among Older Americans Rising?
with J. Michael Collins and Erik Hembre; Regional Science and Urban Economics, 2020

State Financial Education Mandates and the Debt Behavior of Young Adults
with A. Brown, JM. Collins, and M. Schmeiser; Economics of Education Review, 2020

Financial Well-being over the Life Cycle
with J. Michael Collins; European Journal of Finance, 2019

The Effects of Financial Education Graduation Requirements on Postsecondary Financing Decisions
with Christiana Stoddard; Journal of Money, Credit, and Banking, 2019

The Effects of a Foreclosure Moratorium on Loan Repayment Behaviors
with J. Michael Collins; Regional Science and Urban Economics, 2018

Does Salient Student Loan Information Affect College Students' Academic and Borrowing Behavior?
with Christiana Stoddard and Maximilian Schmeiser; Economics of Education Review, 2016

The Role of Information on Retirement Planning: Evidence from a Field Study
with J. Michael Collins; Economic Inquiry, 2016

Rolling the Dice on Foreclosure Prevention: Differences Across Mortgage Servicers in Loan Cure Rates
with J. Michael Collins and Carolina Reid; Housing Policy Debate, 2015

Student Loan Information Provision and Academic Choices
with Max Schmeiser and Christiana Stoddard; American Economic Review Papers & Proceedings 2016 106 : 324 – 328.

Mandatory Mediation Laws and the Renegotiation Mortgage Contracts
with J. Michael Collins; Economic Journal 2015 125:589, 1734 – 1763

Mortgage Loan Modifications and Differential Outcomes by Race
with J. Michael Collins and Carolina Reid; Cityscape 2015 15:1, 164 – 187

The Dark Side of Sunshine: Regulatory Oversight and Status Quo Bias
with J. Michael Collins; Journal of Economics, Behavior, and Organization 2014 107-B:470 – 486

POLITICAL ECONOMY

Partisan Gerrymandering and Turnout
with Daniel Jones and Neil Silveus, Journal of Law and Economics, 2023

The Effect of Local House Prices on Campaign Contributions
with Rebecca Lessem and Sarah Niebler, Economics and Politics, 2022

Does Negative Advertising Affect Giving Behavior? Evidence from Campaign Contributions
with Sarah Niebler; Journal of Public Economics, 2017

Negative Advertising and Political Competition
with Amit Gandhi and Daniela Iorio; Journal of Law, Economics, and Organization, 2015, Won best paper award

Local Economic Growth from Primary Election Spending
with Rebecca Lessem; Economic Journal, 2015

Dollars on the Sidewalk: Should U.S. Presidential Candidates Advertise in Uncontested States?
with Sarah Niebler; American Journal of Political Science 2014 58:2, 322–336

PUBLIC ECONOMICS

Access to Mental Health Resources and SSI
with Matt Messel and Isaac Swensen, Labour Economics, 2023

Housing Assistance and SSI
with Erik Hembre, National Tax Journal, 2023

Personal Belief Exemptions for Required School-Entry Vaccines, Vaccination Rates, and Test Scores
with Nicole Hair and Anja Gruber, Journal of Health Economics, 2021

The Effect of State-Mandated PCV Daycare Vaccinations on PCV Vaccination Rates

with Nicole Hair and Anja Gruber, American Journal of Preventive Medicine, 2021

Is Smoking Inferior? Evidence from Variation in the Earned Income Tax Credit

with Donald Kenkel and Maximilian Schmeiser; Journal of Human Resources 2014 49:4, 1094 – 1120

Working Papers

Why is Financial Literacy Declining? Evidence from Randomizing Device Type

R&R at Journal of Financial Economics, with Jeremy Burke and Olivia Valdes, 2025

The Complementary Effects of Financial Education and Payday Lending Regulations on Financial Inclusion

Under Review, with Aditi Routh, 2025

What is the Educational Cost of Mandating Personal Finance Education?

2025

The Devil is in the Details: State-mandated Personal Finance Education and Financial Well-being

Under Review, with J. Michael Collins, 2025

Work in Progress

What Kind of Financial Information are Young Investors and Non-Investors getting on Social Media?

with Olivia Valdes

Can Financial Education Reduce the Black-White Wealth Gap?

with Melody Harvey and Shogher Ohannessian

Selected Grants and Awards

In the last 14 years, I have been awarded over \$2.5 million in external research funding. Below is a selection of awards and grants.

Money Awareness and Inclusion Awards (MAIA) Top 50 Money Changemakers

Worldwide, \$0

2025

Can Financial Education Reduce the Black-White Wealth Gap?

w M Harvey & S Ohannessian

NEFE, \$309,000

2023-26

Older investors use of new sources of financial advice

MSU Portion of TIAA/Bottner Foundation: \$30,814.00

2025-26

Proposal for Research-based Findings on High School Financial Education

NGPF: \$250,000

2025-26

Why is Financial Literacy Declining

w Jeremy Burke and Olivia Valdes

MSU Portion of FINRA Foundation Grant: \$20,000

2024-25

Financial Education Requirements by School District

Next Gen Personal Finance, \$280,000

2019-24

Health, Disability and Financial Well-Being during the Pandemic

RDRC Grant, \$65,089

2022

Financial Education and Retirement Savings

w Melody Harvey

TIAA Foundation, \$62,000

2020-2021

Financial Education Requirements by School District

Next Gen Personal Finance, \$176,000

2019-2022

The Financial Capability of Young Adults Not Attaining Postsecondary Education w J Michael Collins

FINRA Investor Education Foundation, \$124,846

2019-2020

Youth Bank Accounts and Later-in-Life Financial and Economic Self-Sufficiency

w J Michael Collins

Center for Financial Education and Capability (BBVA), €10,000

2018-2019

The Effects of Financial Education on Postsecondary Education Outcomes w C. Stoddard

National Endowment for Financial Education, \$153,429

2017-2018

Financial Education Research

U.S. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, \$118,000

2017-2020

Student Loans: the Great Equalizer or Another Hurdle for Low Income Students? <i>Spencer Foundation, \$45,491</i>	w C. Stoddard 2016
Student Loans, Financial Counseling, and Economic Opportunity <i>Spencer Foundation, \$35,804</i>	w C. Stoddard 2015-2016
State Financial Education Mandates and Later-Life Outcomes <i>FINRA Investor Education Foundation; \$71,807</i>	2014-2015

Policy Impact and Public Engagement

Datasets Maintained for Public Use: Database of datasets containing the Big 3 and Big 5 financial literacy measures, state high school graduation requirement data, local high school personal finance course requirements and offerings across America.

Media: Top national and international media outlets have covered my research and/or interviewed me for pieces. These include: the New York Times, the Wall Street Journal, TIME, NPR, NPR's Marketplace, the Economist, CNBC (video), NBC news, the Boston Globe, MONEY, MarketWatch, Bloomberg News, Vox, among others.

Policy Briefs: I write issue briefs to accompany most academic papers I wrote, in order to support a lay audience. I maintain an always free Substack account, where I explain financial education research findings for a broad audience.

Keynote Speaker: Mannheim Institute of Financial Education Annual Conference
German Council of Economic Education
Oklahoma City Branch of the Kansas City Federal Reserve Bank at "Jump\$tart your Money Week"
NeighborWorks and Montana Board of Housing's "Montana Housing Conference"

Academic Conference & Seminar Presentations

2024-2025: University of Memphis Department of Economics, University at Buffalo Department of Economics, Stanford Financial Education Bootcamp

2023-2024: Mannheim Financial Education Institute (Keynote and academic talk), Washington Office of Public Instruction, Financial Literacy & Asset-based Engagement Webinar, Next Gen Personal Finance Speaker Series, NAIFA Montana: 10 Myths and Realities of the Current Economy, NEFE Webinar: How to write a manuscript with policy impact (for researchers)/How to read a manuscript (for policymakers), National Association of State Treasurers Panel in Pittsburgh

2022-2023: Cherry Blossom Financial Education Institute, University of St. Andrews Centre for Responsible Banking, First Turino Workshop on Financial Literacy, NEFE Board Meeting presentation

2021-2022: RAND Santa Monica, Association of Public Policy and Management Annual Conference, CTE Conference

2020-2021: Association of Public Policy and Management Annual Conference, Retirement and Disability Research Consortium Annual Conference, University of Wisconsin-Madison Household Finance Seminar, Federal Reserve Bank of New York

2019-2020: Texas A&M, University of Wisconsin-Madison RDRC Conference, CSU-Fullerton, FINRA Foundation Board of Directors, CFPB Financial Well-being Conference, Retirement and Savings Institute HEC Montreal

2018-2019: EduFin Summit (Buenos Aires), University of Glasgow, IFIN Responsible Finance for Good: Financial literacy, financial technology, and their interactions, AEA Annual Conference, Household Finance Scholars Seminar Series, Cherry Blossom Financial Education Institute

2017-2018: UC-Irvine Economic Self-Sufficiency Policy Research Institute, Montana Data Use Conference, Presentation to the Financial Literacy Education Commission sponsored by the US Treasury Dept, San Diego State University, ACCI Annual Conference, Public Choice Annual Conference

2016-2017: APPAM, Household Finance Working Group (UW-Madison), University of Kentucky Martin School, the George Washington University, University of Georgia, Middlebury College, University of Oregon, University of Wisconsin-Madison Economics Alumni Conference, AEA Annual Conference (discussant), Financial Literacy and Education Commission (FLEC) sponsored by the US Treasury Dept.

2015-2016: APPAM, AEA Public Economic Session for the Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession, Cherry Blossom Financial Education Institute, Council for Economic Education, University of Illinois at Chicago, Boulder Summer Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making, Institute for Research on Poverty Summer Conference

2014-2015: Clemson University, the Federal Reserve Board, APPAM, AEAs, Simon Fraser University, Cherry Blossom Financial Education Institute

2013-2014: Public Choice, The George Washington University, Western Economic Association Annual Meetings, Boulder Summer Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making, Montana State University

2012-2013: APPAM, Midwest Economic Association

2011-2012: UW-Madison Public Seminar, University of Hawaii at Manoa, Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research, University of Montana, Montana State University, University of South Carolina, Oxford University, Boulder Summer Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making

2010-2011: UW-Madison Public Seminar, UW-Whitewater Seminar Series, Association of Public Policy and Management (APPAM) Annual Meetings, Wisconsin Economics Association (WEA), Midwest Economics Association, Institute for Research on Poverty-Ridge Workshop

Teaching Experience

Masters Students Advised at MSU:

Main Advisor: Christian Cox (2015), PhD student at Michigan State Univ

On Committee: Neil Silveus (2017), PhD student at Univ of Pittsburgh

Main Advisor: Lev Parker (2019), Channel Strategy and Business Development at Riviera Partners

On Committee: Kate Salemo (2020), Research Manager & Analyst at JG Research and Evaluation

On Committee: Ridge Peterson (2022), Advisory Services Consultant at Resource Innovations

Main Advisor: Robert Hurly (2026)

Main Advisor: Diana Esters, Tim Cuddy (expected 2027)

PhD Students Advised: Dongwei (David) Shi, University of Kentucky's Martin School of Public Policy (2026)

Classes taught:

Economic Way of Thinking, Econometrics, Intermediate Macroeconomics with Calculus, Intermediate Microeconomics with Calculus, Money and Banking, Principles of Microeconomics, Economics for Public Affairs

Other teaching and mentoring: Instructor (two years) at the weeklong Stanford Institute for Financial Decision-making Annual Bootcamp, Associate Director of Training, RDRC, Junior Scholars Intensive Training Mentor (University of Wisconsin-Madison RDRC)

Professional Service

Editor: Co-editor at the Journal of Policy Analysis and Management

Guest co-editor for Economics of Education Review Special Issue on "Financial Literacy and Financial Education"

Associate editor at the Journal of Financial Literacy and Well-being

Referee: American Economic Review, American Economic Journal - Applied Economics, American Economic Journal - Economic Policy, B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy, Contemporary Economic Policy, Economics of Education Review, Economic Inquiry, Economic Journal, International Review of Economic Education, Journal of Consumer Affairs, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Law, Economics, and Organization, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Politics, Management Science, Psychological Reports, Review of Economics of the Household

Languages

English (*native*), French (*proficient*)